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are similar to viroids but they are always linked with larger molecules of the viral RNA.

Prions were discovered by Stanley B. Prusiner in the year 1982 and are proteinaceous infectious particles. They are the causative agents for about a dozen fatal degenerative disorders of the central nervous system of humans and other animals. For example Creutzfeldt – Jakob Disease (CJD), Bovine Spongiform Encephalopathy (BSE) – commonly known as mad cow disease and scrapie disease of sheep.

Viruses infecting blue green algae are called **Cyanophages** and are first reported by Safferman and Morris in the year 1963(Example LPP1 - *Lyngbya, Plectonema* and *Phormidium*). Similarly, Hollings(1962) reported viruses infecting cultivated Mushrooms and causing die back disease. The viruses attacking fungi are called **Mycoviruses** or **Mycophages.**

1.2.8 Viral diseases

Viruses are known to cause disease in plants, animals and Human beings (Figure 1.6). A list of viral disease is given in Table 1.3

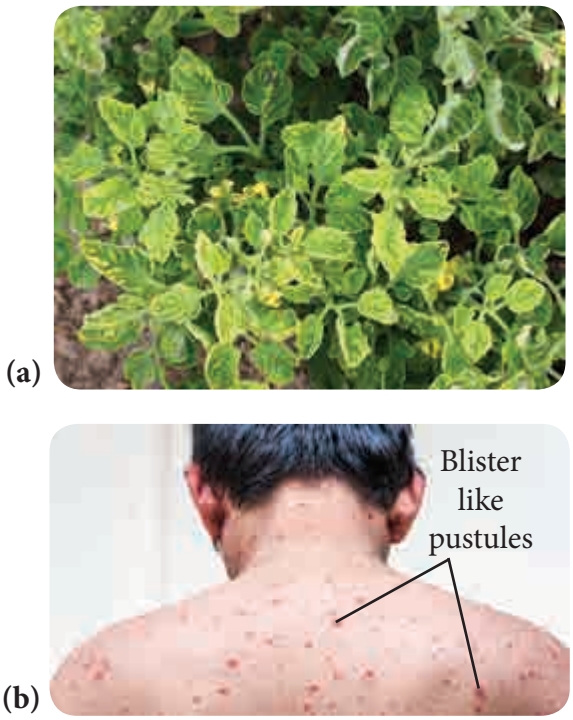


Figure 1.6: Viral diseases (a) Mosaic disease of tomato, (b) Symptom of Chicken pox

Table 1.3: Viral diseases

Plant diseases	Animal diseases	Human diseases
1.Tobacco mosaic	1. Foot and mouth disease of cattle	1. Common cold
2. Cauliflower mosaic	2. Rabies of dog	2. Hepatitis B
3. Sugarcane mosaic	3. Encephalomyelitis of horse	3. Cancer
4. Potato leaf roll		4. SARS(Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome)
5. Bunchy top of banana		5. AIDS(Acquired Immuno Deficiency Syndrome)
6. Leaf curl of papaya		6. Rabies
7. Vein clearing of Lady's finger		7. Mumps
8. Rice tungro disease		8. Polio
9. Cucumber mosaic		9. Chikungunya
10. Tomato mosaic disease		10. Small Pox
		11. Chicken pox
		12. Measles